

Key Points

- Decade of Decision
- Pres. Monson: “Your patriarchal blessing is to you a personal Liahona to chart your course and guide your way” (Oct. 1986 General Conference)
- Pres. Monson: “It is the Spirit that conveys the true meaning. Your blessing is not to be folded neatly and tucked away....It is to be read...loved...and followed. [It] will see you through the darkest night...[and] through life’s dangers.” (Oct 1986)
- It works for us according to our faith in God (Alma 37:40-41)
- Lehi’s family learned how to use the Liahona
- What do we need to learn so we can better use our own personal Liahona

A Tale of Two Trees

Coast Redwood and Giant Sequoia

Coast Redwood vs. Giant Sequoia

(Same Subfamily)

Coast Redwoods:

Up to 380 ft. tall (tallest on earth)

Rarely exceeds 22 ft. in diameter

Lives near California coast

Two types of leaves

- Upper leaves for photosynthesis
- Mid-canopy leaves for water from fog (water drip and absorption)

Lives up to 1,800 years

Giant Sequoia:

Up to 300 ft. tall

Up to 30+ feet in diameter

Largest wood volume on earth

Lives on slopes of Sierra Nevada Mtns

Thrives on snowmelt with shallow root system spreading out 300 feet

Lives up to 3,500 years (Moses was likely talking to God at the burning bush when seedling started.)





Redwood Leaves



GIANT SEQUOIA

Sequoiadendron giganteum

Average height at maturity:
250–275 feet

Average diameter at
maturity: 15–20 feet



COAST REDWOOD

Sequoia sempervirens

Average height at maturity:
200+ feet

Average diameter at
maturity: 6–15 feet

Lessons from the Redwoods

- The redwoods don't wait for the rain; they absorb the fog that is already there
- Our Savior created a specialized canopy for the trees to receive the water
- We often receive revelation through the still, small voice that is always there (Redwoods can't receive water if they're thrashing in the wind; find a quiet place to ponder, pray, and be still)
- Growth is slow and cumulative
- Trials and adversity allow new growth to occur

Revelation – the Lord’s Pattern

- D&C 1:31-32 (Repent)
- D&C 6:14-15 (We have already received revelation)
- D&C 6:22-23 (He speaks peace to our minds)
- D&C 8:2-3 (He tells us in our minds and hearts)
- D&C 9:7-9 (We need to study it out first, then ask Him)
- D&C 11:13-14 (He will enlighten our minds and fill our soul with joy; have faith)
- D&C 112:10 (Be humble)
- 1 Nephi 17:45 (God speaks with still, small voice; we need to be able to feel it)

Redwood Canopy

- R – Repent Daily
- E – Expect God to Speak
- D – Decide Early to Follow Him
- W – Watch for Small Signs
- O – Obey God’s Commands
- O – Others Help Us Stand
- D – Dedicate a “Leaf” for Inspiration
- C – Consecrate Daily Time
- A – Adversity is Part of the Plan
- N – Nourish Gratitude
- O – Observe the World Around You
- P – Ponder in Stillness
- Y – Yield to the Word of God

Personal Observations

- Enos was right.... “Wrestle with God” = Earnest pleading with God through the Spirit
- Expect to receive answers...God answers sincere questions quickly; other may come later
- **Direct answers** are often found in the scriptures, conference talks, or in other good books
- Answers may be clearly dictated messages or an image to our minds
- The ‘Burning in the Bosom’ is real, but answers are usually the small feelings of peace
- In an emergency, the Spirit may give direct, strong, and immediate warnings
- Even if you’re doing good, sometimes answers are hard to get; God wants us to act in faith (He will not let us go too far down the wrong path without a warning or feeling of unease)
- Heed the feelings of unease or confusion; those are negative answers
- Act on feelings you think are from God; if it was correct, remember it; if not, try again
- If I think I have received an impression, I retrace my thought process